

Iván Cárdenas-León

Geospatial Specialist · PhD Candidate

Website | LinkedIn | Github | ilcardenas26@gmail.com | +31 0686185983

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UNOPS Indonesia
Enschede, Netherlands

Job Application for Research Data Steward

Dear recruiting team

My name is Iván Cárdenas-León, I am currently in the last year of my PhD in Urban Digital Twins at the ITC faculty. Through this letter, I would like to apply for the position of Satellite Imagery Analysis Specialist. I consider that my coding abilities coupled with my solution driven mindset and eight years of experience as an Environmental Engineer and researcher makes me a great candidate for this role.

In my current research I am developing **CrossTwin**, an open-source Urban Digital Twin platform across three urban sectors: drinking water supply, heat stress, and housing provision, which I expect turns into a software product and publication. Alongside this, I have built and deployed real operational tools: a Bibliographic reference enricher through CrossRef, Openalex and Semantic Scholar; a Streamlit web application for Circular Energy scenario analysis; a Python Panel monitoring dashboard for Vitens, the Dutch drinking water authority; and a ArcGIS Experience and geoprocessing tool for heat stress which allows for scenario-based modelling, impact assessment, and environmental cost analysis. For all of my research I have constantly used Git and GitHub for version control and collaboration. In my work I regularly use AI tools including Claude code and other LLM-assisted coding to accelerate prototyping and demo development. One of my publications includes a peer-reviewed Data paper as a result of a systematic literature review on the indicators used to monitor and evaluate impacts of planning decisions.

Beyond research, I have delivered applied geospatial solutions in consulting roles across Colombia and the Netherlands, including Satellite imagery processing and analysis; UAV imagery pipelines; Geo-database management with ETL pipelines and metadata management on environmental impact assessment projects, mining, energy transmission, flood risk modeling, Oil & Gas exploitation, and urban planning; and Web-GIS development using Mapbox GL and JavaScript. At Philips, I replaced a manual biodiversity spreadsheets workflow with an interactive global manufacturing site map integrating satellite and API-based land-use data. On both academic and consulting projects I have handled different data types and storage systems, including satellite imagery, databases, text files, spreadsheets and images with their corresponding metadata traceability and version control.

My work experience in multi cultural and multi disciplinary environments has allowed me to learn how to manage and communicate complex projects and solutions to different audiences. Likewise I understand the importance of having standardized tools for data management and imagery analysis so information can be easily shared, accessed and used. My knowledge and skills in this areas, and my expertise in geospatial analysis and analytical processes can be a great asset to DISHA's workflows for rapid damage assessment following typhoons, floods, earthquakes and other natural disasters that are also common in Colombia, except the typhoons of course. I believe that my skills can support the development of reusable and scalable solutions for the South East Asia regional office.

On the personal side, I have been living with my partner in Enschede, Netherlands for the past five years, and in my free time I play tycoon and strategy videogames, play beach volleyball, go hiking, find creative inspiration from illustrators, as of late, I am also been enjoying taking photographs of nature, animals and architecture.

Hoping to hear from you soon!

Sincerely,

Iván Cárdenas-León

PhD Candidate in Urban Planning, University of Twente

ilcardenas26@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/ivancardenasleon](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ivancardenasleon)